

Nursing Route Comparison and Decision

NAME _____ DATE _____ PERIOD _____

Your path: See one completed route. Try one with support. Compare two more routes. Then recommend one route for a fictional student.

1. See one: Nursing assistant

This model shows how to keep four kinds of evidence attached to one career.

EVIDENCE JOB	COMPLETED MODEL
Preparation	State-approved education program; state competency or certification requirements vary
Route detail	A student must verify the exact state and program requirements
Pay label	\$39,530 • May 2024 • U.S. median
Responsibility	Measure vital signs and report patient concerns to a nurse

Why the model works: The pay figure keeps its year, geography, and measure. The responsibility names work the person does. The route detail tells the student what still needs verification.

2. Try one together: Licensed vocational nurse

Use the evidence bank. Mark **P** beside preparation, **\$** beside pay, and **R** beside responsibility.

- ☐ State-approved vocational nursing program, typically about one year, then licensure
- ☐ \$62,340 • May 2024 • U.S. median
- ☐ Provide basic medical care and document patient status

Complete the route statement with the marked evidence:

An LVN commonly completes _____

before _____.

One responsibility is _____.

The pay evidence is _____.

Stop and Jot: What changes from the nursing assistant route to the LVN route?

3. Compare: RN and nurse practitioner

Read both route cards. Underline preparation, circle the pay label, and box one responsibility on each card.

Registered nurse (RN)

Approved nursing program through an associate, bachelor's, or diploma route, then RN licensure. May 2024 U.S. median: **\$93,600**. RNs assess patients, coordinate care, and monitor equipment.

Nurse practitioner

RN preparation plus graduate education and advanced-practice licensure. May 2024 U.S. median: **\$129,210**. Nurse practitioners assess, diagnose, and manage patient care within state scope.

Put all four careers in order from lowest to highest May 2024 U.S. median. Include each figure.

Name one preparation difference between the RN and nurse practitioner routes.

Name one responsibility difference. Do not say only that one role has “more responsibility.”

4. RN route check: Verify before choosing

Both associate and bachelor's programs can be pre-licensure RN routes. In Texas, the student must verify that the program is approved by the Texas Board of Nursing. Program length, cost, admission, transfer options, and employer preferences can differ.

Circle two facts that matter most for **Avery**, who wants to become an RN and limit time away from paid work:

program approval • program length • cost and aid • admission • transfer options • employer preferences

Which route should Avery investigate first: associate degree or bachelor's degree? Name one possible advantage and one fact Avery must verify.

5. Decide: Make a route recommendation

Choose a fictional student for the final recommendation:

- ☐ **Jordan** wants the shortest approved route into direct patient support.
- ☐ **Avery** wants the RN route that best fits work, cost, and long-term plans.
- ☐ **Sam** wants advanced responsibility and accepts graduate school.

Recommended route: _____

Preparation or license evidence: _____

Pay evidence with year, geography, and measure: _____

Trade-off or fact to verify: _____

Complete the frame, then add any detail you need: **I recommend** _____ **for**
_____ **because**

Done when

- ☐ I completed the LVN practice and compared all four careers.
- ☐ I labeled U.S. median, local figure, or starting pay correctly.
- ☐ I named a preparation or responsibility difference.
- ☐ My recommendation uses evidence and one trade-off or fact to verify.